



Market research

Information on conducting market research and obtaining relevant statistics

US

Market research and competitive analysis
www.sba.gov/business-guide/plan-your-business/market-research-competitive-analysis

Canada

Canadian industry statistics
www.ic.gc.ca/app/scr/app/cis/search-recherche?lang=eng
Conducting market research
www.canada.ca/en/services/business/research/conductingmarketresearch.html

TEMPLATES AND TOOLS

Hundreds of free and reasonably priced templates and software programs are available for small businesses, which can save you time and energy. As soon as you begin planning your business, join local business owners' groups on social media, and ask for recommendations for the programs and templates that will be the most useful to you. Here are some programs that apply to a wide range of business types:

Graphics

If you need to make graphics, you can use a program like Canva to create professional-looking graphics and marketing materials with a consistent look. For themed memes, the WordSwag app lets you create consistent, clean memes from your phone.

Marketing and social media marketing

You will need to market your business by email, using a program that can collect opt-ins from your customers. ConvertKit, MailChimp, and Kartra are popular programs that maintain your lists and send emails. If you are selling to consumers, you will need to do social media marketing, too. Your email marketing program may be able to integrate

your social media campaigns, but also consider stand-alone programs such as Hootsuite, Later, or Tailwind.

Search engine optimization (SEO)

Programs like Google Search and Moz can help you improve your SEO to get more targeted traffic to your site and help you plan content and ad campaigns that combine with your static site content.

Analytics

Google Analytics is a free program that can track where your website traffic comes from and what people do when they get to your site. Even if you don't have much traffic to your site, it is worth installing so you have the numbers as you grow.

Bookkeeping

QuickBooks, FreshBooks, and NetSuite are three common, easy-to-use small business bookkeeping systems that will keep you organized.

Market research

If you are doing market research, you can use survey programs such as Survey Monkey or Google Forms to collect and organize responses.